The Philosopher Who Led Me Toward Suffering Abolition: An Open Letter to David Pearce and a Documentary History of Our Disagreement

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Abstract

David Pearce's review of *Brave New World* introduced me to the formal suffering-abolition project and helped me give philosophical vocabulary to a moral concern I had held since childhood. This participant-authored scholarly polemic records how that intellectual debt became a named philosophical criticism. I contend that Pearce's continued externalist commitment, and repeated failure to address the specific answers I supplied to his objections, contribute to preserving conceptual conditions under which suffering can be discounted. The accusation concerns philosophical consequences and conduct in an exchange; it does not accuse Pearce of endorsing torture. I consolidate a dispersed record of public replies, author-preserved conversation excerpts, published responses, and journal correspondence, distinguishing non-materialist physicalism from materialism and Experiential Empiricism from personal solipsism. The direct open letter remains the emotional center. The surrounding history connects the other-minds dispute to Hedonic Core, suffering prevention, AI alignment, institutional recognition, and neglected cryonics questions. The contribution is the consolidation and interpretation of this philosophical and interpersonal record, offered for independent criticism and future citation.

Keywords: David Pearce, Experiential Empiricism, suffering abolition, negative utilitarianism, non-materialist physicalism, other minds, Hedonic Core, AI alignment, philosophical correspondence, intellectual history

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Scope, method, and archival note

This is a participant-authored scholarly polemic, a named philosophical criticism, and a documentary intellectual history. I do not claim neutrality about Pearce. I commit to accurate attribution, inspectable evidence, and distinctions between what happened, what I argue follows philosophically, and what I personally judge about the exchange. Anger is part of the history being recorded. It is not a substitute for evidence.

The source hierarchy is public correspondence and comments, preserved exchange transcripts and screenshots, my published philosophical responses, and retrospective interpretation. Only exchanged statements are evidence of what either participant said to the other. Public-page retrieval recovered the latest Facebook branch without establishing that every comment was available. Relative platform timestamps remain relative timestamps. Writing-process records, prompting and links to them are excluded from this publication.

Some retrieval gaps arise from the walled gardens in which these exchanges occurred. Facebook and X can leave public-facing discussions difficult to retrieve as complete, independently inspectable records: restricted automated access, login barriers, collapsed branches, and incomplete rendered views obstruct reconstruction. I regard this hostility to AI-assisted retrieval as "AI hate" built into the platforms' walled-garden construction. That is my judgment about the obstruction, not evidence of a particular corporate motive. Failure to recover a comment through those barriers is not evidence that the exchange never happened. Nor can the barriers supply a missing quotation, date, or final sent version. The preserved public captures and transcripts carry the claims made here; inaccessible portions remain identified as inaccessible.

Private messages marked against publication are excluded from the documentary appendix. No inference about Pearce's private motives is established by repetition, an apology, silence, or friendship status. Where I call a response an evasion, that is my judgment about its argumentative relation to an answer already supplied. The evidence for that judgment is presented alongside the objection. Missing evidence remains missing.

The novel contribution is this record of influence, disagreement, attempted transmission, and its interpretation. It is not the invention of another general theory of epistemic exclusion or another standalone proof of EE. The bibliography is a research guide to the arguments this history presupposes. PhilPapers and PhilArchive availability is distinguished throughout from peer-reviewed journal acceptance. Sources and their limits are indexed in Sections 11 and 12.

1. Intellectual debt and formal accusation

I need to explain why David Pearce matters so much to this story, because without that history my anger is easily mistaken for resentment toward an established philosopher who declined to endorse my work. That is not what happened. My concern with suffering began in grade school, with my own encounter with the problem of evil. Long before I knew the vocabulary of negative utilitarianism, consciousness studies, or artificial intelligence alignment, I had reached the conviction that suffering

was the fundamental moral emergency.

Years later, I encountered David Pearce through his review of Aldous Huxley's *Brave New World*. That was my introduction to the intellectual world of suffering abolition. Pearce gave me language, context, and an existing philosophical project for something I had been trying to articulate since childhood. His work helped turn an early moral conviction into a formal target. My work on suffering prevention and AI alignment, including Hedonic Core, formed the project from which I subsequently developed Experiential Empiricism. This was not a conversion to caring about suffering. Pearce helped me discover and formalize the relevant intellectual territory; he did not originate my childhood moral insight. The relationship between the alignment project, EE, and Reality Repair Theory is documented in Experiential Empiricism and Reality Repair Theory: A Comprehensive Historical Genealogy and developed below.

That is why I sought Pearce out on Twitter. That is why I wanted to speak with him. That is why I respected him. I did not approach him as an adversary. I approached him as someone whose life's work appeared to be directed toward the same problem I had been trying to solve. And that is what makes the present criticism so severe.

I am formally accusing David Pearce of helping perpetuate the conceptual conditions under which suffering can be systematically discounted, despite having devoted his intellectual career to its abolition.

This is not an accusation that Pearce personally endorses torture or wishes suffering upon anyone. His published ethical commitments point in the opposite direction. It is an accusation concerning the consequences of his philosophical commitments and his response to a challenge directed at them. His non-materialist physicalism takes experience seriously as the intrinsic nature of reality, yet retains an independently existing physical ontology. Experiential Empiricism challenges the necessity and justification of that remaining externalist commitment. My ethical argument is that externalism enables the promotion of supposedly objective models and classifications above the experiences they are intended to describe. Once suffering requires validation by an allegedly more fundamental external authority, institutions acquire a mechanism for discounting it.

I have argued that this mechanism contributes to the organization and rationalization of suffering on a scale far beyond individual cruelty. I have also argued that EE offers a way to eliminate that particular conceptual permission structure without sacrificing science, empirical investigation, or the practical recognition of other sentient beings. These claims may be disputed. They deserve to be disputed seriously. But if they are correct, the implications for suffering abolition and AI alignment are enormous. And that is why Pearce's response matters.

I have not merely offered him an unfamiliar metaphysical theory. I have presented an argument that, if successful, identifies a foundational obstacle to the ethical project we both regard as urgent. He has repeatedly returned to the concern that EE fails to acknowledge other minds, despite the answers I supplied explaining why it does not. He has also offered actual arguments and proposals, especially concerning physical explanation and thalamic bridges. The criticism is that these responses leave the specific challenge unresolved, as Section 6 documents.

I regard that repeated misrepresentation, together with his failure to help bring the disagreement be-

fore independent critics, as a consequential failure of intellectual responsibility. The accusation extends beyond Pearce personally. It concerns everyone who claims to prioritize the abolition of suffering while allowing inherited metaphysical commitments, institutional conventions, or professional incentives to take precedence over examining a potentially relevant challenge. I am not claiming that agreement with EE is a prerequisite for ethical seriousness. I am claiming that the ethical seriousness of suffering abolition creates a corresponding responsibility to examine arguments that might materially affect its foundations.

Especially when those arguments come from someone who has spent months documenting them, publishing responses to objections, and explicitly requesting independent criticism. Pearce was not obligated to become my advocate. He was not obligated to agree with me, publish my work, or devote unlimited time to it. But he was someone I admired, someone whose work helped shape my intellectual development, and someone who repeatedly chose to participate in this discussion. Once he entered that exchange, his responses became legitimate subjects of philosophical criticism.

I am recording that criticism here. Not because I expect him to change his mind. Not because I expect an academic institution to vindicate me. And not because I imagine this paper will suddenly make EE acceptable. I am recording it because the intellectual history of suffering abolition should include its serious internal disagreements, including accusations that prominent proponents have failed to examine challenges to their own assumptions. A future account of Pearce's work should be able to identify this criticism, understand its philosophical basis, and inspect the documented exchange.

A future account of EE should likewise record the influence Pearce had on its development, the disagreements that followed, and the author's assessment of their ethical significance.

The person who helped me recognize the formal philosophical shape of my life's central moral problem is now the person I am accusing of helping preserve one of the mechanisms that keeps that problem alive.

That is not a contradiction I can simply leave undocumented.

2. What EE says, and why suffering is at stake

For anyone encountering Experiential Empiricism for the first time, here is the foundational challenge in ordinary language. Its fuller defense is in Experientia Est: Name One Thing That Is Not a Subset of Experience, The Three-Step Argument, and Closed for Business.

Experience is what reality is made of.

Not matter. Not energy. Not spacetime. Not mathematics, logic, mind, God, or some invisible metaphysical substrate behind everything we encounter. Experience. Experience is not merely a window through which we observe an independently existing reality. It is the medium in which reality exists, the substance of its contents, the primordial floor and core of existence itself.

Experience is what ISness is.

Everything real belongs to reality. There cannot be an outside to the totality of everything that exists, because anything existing in that supposed outside would already be included in the totality. And

whatever we propose as fundamental, whether particles, fields, mathematical relations, consciousness, causation, or the universe itself, we must still answer the same question:

What is it actually made of? What is its existence?

Every possible answer, every conceivable attribute, every demonstration, every logical relation, and every piece of evidence is experience. Even the logic by which we attempt to establish something beyond experience is itself more experience. This is not the claim that my personal mind invented the universe. My mind, my memories, my body, other people, stars, galaxies, physical laws, and the entirety of cosmological history are all included in the reality being discussed. None of them is being dismissed. The claim is about what reality fundamentally IS, not about which individual happens to be experiencing it.

The obvious realist objection deserves an explicit answer: does this merely show that we know reality through experience, rather than that reality is constituted by experience? The first proposition alone does not entail the second. A description belongs to experience; that fact by itself does not prove that its proposed referent does. Nor does totality closure, by itself, identify the constitution of the totality. EE's further argument challenges the additional ontological posit: what content, distinction, or explanatory work establishes a non-experiential constitution beyond the experiential regularities already doing the work? Inference can establish patterns, predictions, and compelling practical reasons for recognizing other subjects. I contest the further promotion of that success into authentication of an independently constituted outside. The realist may defend that promotion as inference to the best explanation; the burden is then to show what the added ontology explains that the retained experiential structure does not. That is the disputed step developed in The Three-Step Argument and The Free Rider Problem in Scientific Realism. It is not settled merely by noting that evidence is experienced. My conclusion is the stronger ontological claim: Experience is the primordial constitution of reality. This concise presentation identifies its argumentative burden; it does not pretend that the epistemic premise alone has discharged it.

Nor does EE deny science. Science is extraordinarily successful at identifying, describing, predicting, and manipulating regularities in experience. EE retains those discoveries and their practical consequences. It simply refuses the additional, unsupported promotion of our descriptions into an allegedly more fundamental reality beyond experience. And this is where the entire argument becomes almost embarrassingly simple.

Name one thing that is not a subset of experience.

Not a word for something allegedly outside it. Not a mathematical model of something allegedly outside it. Not an inference that such a thing must exist. Identify what it is, what it consists of, and how its existence can be coherently distinguished from experience. If you cannot, why are you adding it? That's the argument. Experience is. Everything real is included in reality. Experience is the only medium in which anything can be identified, constituted, or coherently specified as existing.

Experience Is. What IS is.

You can reject that conclusion. You can attempt to identify an equivocation, a contradiction, or an alternative ontology. I welcome that. But you cannot refute it by accusing me of believing that other people are imaginary, because nothing in this argument says that. You cannot refute it by describing

more elaborate physical models, because those models are themselves part of what the argument encompasses. And you cannot refute it by declaring that reality must extend beyond experience, because that is precisely the additional assumption under dispute.

That is what I have spent months asking people to address. Everything that follows concerns what happened when I tried to get that extraordinarily simple argument examined.

The current formulation has one axiom: **Experience is.** Logic is the structural aspect of experience, rather than an independent foundation placed above it; valence names its affective aspect. Logic as Structural Valence: Why Experiential Empiricism's Two Axioms Are One records the correction from earlier presentations that listed logic and valenced experience separately. That development belongs in the intellectual history rather than being silently projected backward into every earlier exchange.

Totality closure and the identification of that totality as experiential are distinguishable steps. That everything real cannot have an outside does not, by itself, prove EE. The second claim requires the argument about what can constitute or coherently specify reality. A critic can challenge that identification, my account of justification, or the inference from experiential evidence to ontology. Those are real philosophical questions. Calling EE personal solipsism does not answer them.

Nor does experiential totality establish a single universal subject. Everything real includes any other experiencing that exists, but inclusion does not prove that we share one phenomenal field, that I created yours, or that my autobiography exhausts reality. My practical recognition of other sentient beings and my refusal to certify a metaphysical exterior are different commitments. The later Why I Cannot Prove Mine or Discard Yours, published October 5, 2026 according to the canonical publication record, makes the identity and other-minds distinction explicit; its publication alone is not proof of Pearce's receipt. Epistemic Honesty and the Other Minds Question in Experiential Empiricism addresses that distinction.

3. The open letter to Dave

This letter preserves my October 11, 2026 direct address, not a transcript of a message proved to have been sent. Its account of public exposure is updated in Section 6.8. Its accusations of evasion and its expressions of disbelief are my judgments. Section 6 gives the documentary basis and the limits of those judgments. The question is not whether Pearce believes his own account is compassionate. It is whether its conditions for moral recognition withstand the challenge.

Dear Dave,

At this point I find it increasingly difficult to believe you don't understand what you're doing. EE does not deny your existence. It does not reduce you to a zombie, a figment of my imagination, or something I can abuse without consequence. I've explained this repeatedly, in comments and in formal papers. Yet your replies keep making moral recognition contingent on the externalist commitment I've explicitly rejected. It's very simple. Reality includes everything real. If some alleged outside exists, it is necessarily included in reality. Calling it "outside" doesn't exempt it from that totality. Now name a single attribute of this alleged outside that isn't experience. Not experience merely as a conduit to something else, but experience as the exhaustive medium of everything that can coherently be specified, including existence, logic, time, causation, and the abstractions you're using to argue with me.

You are as real to me as the Sun, the dirt, and everything else I encounter. I have overwhelming reasons to treat you as a sentient being. What I refuse to do is invent an inaccessible duplicate behind the David Pearce I actually encounter and then pretend that duplicate is somehow more real than the experience from which every claim about him derives. You keep accusing me of solipsism because I refuse to grant your metaphysical realism. But you cannot demonstrate your proposed independent reality, cannot establish its necessity, and cannot identify what explanatory work it performs that experience and its regularities don't already accomplish. Instead of honoring your burden of proof, you repeatedly assume the conclusion and accuse me of denying other minds.

And the ethical implications are not some optional digression. They're the entire reason this matters. You say that without acknowledging supposedly independent sentient beings, discussion of suffering becomes moot. That is exactly the dangerous inversion I'm attacking. You're making the moral significance of suffering depend on a metaphysical claim you admit you cannot establish. You've placed an unverifiable ontological credential between suffering and our obligation to respond to it. That is the machinery of organized atrocity. Once the experience itself isn't enough, institutions can demand external certification of whose suffering counts. They can elevate their models, classifications, and theories above the suffering those instruments supposedly exist to understand. Individual sadists can inflict pain. Institutions can industrialize its dismissal. Externalism supplies the conceptual permission structure.

You have devoted your life to abolishing suffering. Yet when I present a framework specifically designed to prevent the systematic dismissal of suffering, you repeatedly refuse to engage its central argument and return instead to the accusation that I don't believe people like you are real. That's not a rebuttal. It's an evasion. And I'm tired of pretending this is merely a difficulty of comprehension. For months you've participated in exchanges about EE, repeatedly declared that you don't understand it, and continued making the same objections after I've answered them. I've explicitly asked you to bring it to other philosophers, to introduce it independently to your audience, to find someone who might understand what you say you cannot. You have the reach and professional connections to do that. Yet our discussion remains confined to exchanges that I must initiate or sustain.

If you're genuinely interested in understanding something, why wouldn't you ask someone else? Why wouldn't you test your interpretation against third parties? In what other area of intellectual inquiry would months of professed incomprehension be accompanied by so little apparent effort to resolve it? I cannot know your motives. But I can see the pattern, and I can tell you what it has cost me. I'm homeless, largely ignored, and trying to bring an argument I consider foundational to the attention of people who could examine it seriously. I arrived at EE through my work on alignment and suffering prevention. I believe its implications are enormous. You are among the very few established thinkers who have participated in exchanges about it at all, and you have the ability to expose it to independent scrutiny without endorsing a single word.

Instead, I keep receiving variations of the same misrepresentation, followed by apologies for not understanding. It no longer feels like intellectual disagreement. It feels like being politely dismissed while the substance of my work is left untouched. Whatever your intentions, the effect is to keep EE trapped in a conversation between two people, one of whom must endlessly defend himself against a position he never held. I thought you were my friend. That makes this considerably more painful

than a disagreement with a stranger. I expected intellectual honesty, serious engagement, and at least enough respect to stop attributing to me the very ethical indifference my work exists to oppose.

I don't want another apology or another explanation of why you supposedly cannot understand me. I don't want another question that simply reinstates the premise I've spent months challenging. If you believe EE is wrong, demonstrate where. If you cannot understand it, ask someone who might. If you think it deserves no attention, say so plainly. But stop calling my refusal to invent an inaccessible reality a refusal to recognize suffering beings. That accusation is intellectually indefensible, morally insulting, and exactly backward.

Externalism is oxygen for organized atrocity. You are in a position to help expose and challenge that mechanism, yet you won't even seriously examine the argument. I am no longer willing to spend my time and emotional energy on this exchange. I wanted a collaborator, a critic, or at least a friend willing to engage honestly. What I've experienced instead has been profoundly hurtful. I'm done.

4. To everyone else: why this exchange matters

I know how this sounds. An obscure, homeless independent philosopher claims to have identified a foundational error in centuries of philosophy, accuses established intellectuals of failing to engage, and insists that the consequences may extend to organized atrocity and the prevention of suffering. I know exactly how that looks from the outside. The obvious response is to suspect grandiosity, crankery, obsession, or some combination of the three. I understand that. I would probably be suspicious too. But suspicion is not a counterargument.

I don't have a God complex. If anything, I have a Semmelweis complex. Not because I imagine myself a persecuted genius whose eventual vindication is guaranteed, but because I believe I've identified a consequential error, explained it repeatedly, and watched the people best positioned to examine it continue operating as though the argument had never been made. The historical comparison is specific: evidence can fail to secure recognition, and rejection does not settle the truth of what was rejected. The Semmelweis analogy and its modern institutional form are developed in Section 5.

I'm asking for exactly that examination. If I am wrong, show me where. If my argument is incoherent, identify the contradiction. If I've reinvented something already known, demonstrate the equivalence. If an existing philosophical position defeats EE, explain how it survives the challenge.

A coherent counterargument is all I have ever needed.

5. The modern Semmelweis trap and the journal record

Being rejected does not make someone right. Plenty of rejected ideas deserve rejection. But rejection is not a refutation either. Ignaz Semmelweis demonstrated that handwashing could dramatically reduce maternal mortality, yet encountered resistance from the medical establishment. The historical reference is the WHO Guidelines on Hand Hygiene in Health Care. Today we celebrate him as an example of science eventually correcting itself. But we rarely ask the more uncomfortable question: what would

happen if Semmelweis were alive today, already professionally discredited, and attempting to establish his findings without institutional support?

This is a modern counterfactual, not a claim about the precise circumstances of his historical career. Imagine that he had lost his medical license. He could no longer independently conduct the clinical research necessary to establish his discovery. He would need access to patients, hospitals, ethics approval, research facilities, and collaborators. Who controls those resources? The institutions that have already rejected him. He might be told to publish in a reputable journal, but lack the institutional access needed to produce the evidence expected by that journal. He might be told to obtain independent replication, but find that qualified researchers won't associate with him because his work is already considered disreputable.

And why is it disreputable? Because reputable people won't associate with it.

He cannot obtain recognition without institutional legitimacy, and he cannot obtain institutional legitimacy because he has not been recognized.

Every individual gatekeeper can claim to be following reasonable procedures. Nobody needs to conspire. Nobody even needs to consciously oppose the discovery. The system can exclude the researcher, then cite his exclusion as evidence that his work does not merit consideration. Licensing and research ethics have legitimate purposes. They are not, however, instruments for determining metaphysical truth. Professional authorization and epistemic validity are different questions. Now consider my situation. I am not asking permission to conduct dangerous medical experiments. I am presenting a foundational philosophical argument that anyone capable of following it can examine.

No laboratory is required to identify a false premise. No medical license is required to expose circular reasoning. No university appointment is necessary to demonstrate a contradiction. And yet I have encountered the same circularity of recognition. More importantly, **I have documented it.**

5.1. I submitted the work

Between November 2025 and January 2026, I attempted to obtain institutional evaluation of Experiential Empiricism through three philosophy journals: *Synthese*, *Journal of Consciousness Studies*, and *Analysis*. I subsequently published Institutional Breakdown: How Three Philosophy Journals Responded to Experiential Empiricism, bringing the episodes together. That paper documents three different responses to a foundational challenge. The differences matter because they reveal distinct ways an argument can fail to receive substantive engagement without anyone identifying a defect in its reasoning.

5.2. Synthese: impossibility asserted

My submission to *Synthese* was rejected by Professor Kristie Miller, the Challis Professor of Philosophy at the University of Sydney. The decisive objection, as reproduced in my account, was that no paper could accomplish all the things claimed. The preserved wording is narrower than "no philosophical challenge to realism is possible": it refers to the claimed scope of the paper's accomplishments. My criticism is that the editor asserted their impossibility without giving the argument that established it. But that was precisely the question under examination.

If an argument claims to demonstrate that a foundational assumption is unjustified, dismissing it on the grounds that no argument could demonstrate such a thing assumes the very conclusion that needs defending. I documented this episode separately:

The 'No Paper Could Do This' Defense: A Challis Professor's Circular Dismissal of Foundational Arguments.

The issue is not whether the editor was obligated to publish my paper. She wasn't. The issue is whether the reason supplied identifies an error in the argument or simply rules out its possible success in advance. A claim of impossibility is itself a philosophical claim. It requires justification. If my argument fails, identify where. If the conclusion is impossible, demonstrate why. Do not use the alleged impossibility of the conclusion as a substitute for evaluating the argument offered to establish it.

The local standalone account is internally inconsistent about the December submission sequence: its opening gives a December 5 submission and December 8 exchange, while its submission list gives December 9 and 11 for the three-step paper. I retain the reproduced objection and the November–December 2025 setting, but do not resolve that conflict by inventing a chronology. Its current local manuscript title also differs from the title in my catalog; both are identified in the research guide.

5.3. Journal of Consciousness Studies: scope and threatened escalation

On December 15, 2025, at 10:06 AM in the reproduced email headers, I submitted a paper to the *Journal of Consciousness Studies*. The first response arrived on December 16. Managing Editor Graham Horswell said he had looked over the paper, invoked the journal's scope, and cited subscribers' concerns about the amount of philosophy. He expressly said the decision was not a reflection on the quality of the research and distinguished this decision from rejection following peer review. I cannot turn that letter into an admission that he never read the submission.

Consider what I was submitting. EE begins with the certainty of experience and challenges the inference from experiential evidence to mind-independent material reality. It addresses the foundational assumptions behind the hard problem of consciousness, the explanatory gap, and the mind-body problem. A journal devoted to consciousness declined a consciousness-centered epistemological argument while invoking reader dissatisfaction with the amount of philosophy it published. When I pressed for substantive engagement, I was advised to circulate the work to philosophers such as David Chalmers and Philip Goff. The editor explained that he was not a philosopher and did not wish to mislead me.

I documented the correspondence: "Too Much Philosophy": How the Journal of Consciousness Studies Rejected Consciousness-Centered Epistemology.

Then something remarkable happened. After I published my account, the managing editor discovered it and, on December 22, 2025, asked me to remove the account and said that refusal would lead him to seek legal advice about how to proceed. I regard that conditional escalation as a legal threat. The record does not establish that proceedings were filed. He also expressly disputed the portrayal that he had admitted not reading the paper and objected to my framing of the editorial exchange.

That subsequent exchange is documented in the correspondence appendix of Institutional Break-

down. Think about the asymmetry. A journal can decline to engage an argument. The independent author can publish an account of that refusal. But when the account itself becomes the subject of threatened legal action, the institutional response has moved beyond ordinary editorial discretion. I am not asking readers to accept my interpretation without inspection. The record is available.

Read the correspondence. Decide whether the editorial responses address the philosophical argument. Decide whether the subsequent legal threat was a proportionate response to public documentation. And ask what such an episode communicates to other independent researchers who lack the resources to defend themselves.

5.4. Analysis: comparative judgment without a specified logical error

On January 7, 2026, my submission to *Analysis* received another form of rejection, according to the dated rejection reproduced in my published account. The journal stated that the argument was not as strong as those in other recent submissions. This may be a perfectly ordinary consideration when allocating limited journal space. But as a response to a claimed foundational logical demonstration, it leaves the central question unanswered. What was wrong with the argument? Was a premise false? Was an inference invalid? Was the conclusion already established or previously refuted?

The comparative judgment did not tell me. I documented the episode in: The Comparative Validity Fallacy: How Analysis Rejected a Logical Argument Through Anonymous Competition.

The distinction is important. A journal may reasonably decide that another submission better serves its editorial priorities. That decision does not establish that the rejected argument is false, invalid, or unworthy of examination elsewhere. A comparative editorial decision cannot do the work of a logical rebuttal. Yet to an outsider, another rejection becomes another apparent reason to dismiss the work.

Three journals. Three different responses. No identified fatal error in the foundational argument within the reasons I received. I do not claim that these events prove EE is correct. They do not.

They establish that I sought institutional evaluation and did not receive the kind of substantive counterargument I was seeking.

That is a much narrower claim, and the published correspondence allows readers to evaluate it.

The letter also criticized the paper's connection to recent literature and said the editors lacked resources for further correspondence. Those are editorial reasons, even if I find them inadequate. The record supports my complaint that the supplied reasons did not identify a false premise or invalid inference. It does not establish that the editors conceded validity, attempted a formal refutation, or were incapable of defending their decision privately. My label "Comparative Validity Fallacy" names my criticism of treating this editorial comparison as if it settled the argument.

6. The philosophical and documentary record of the Pearce disagreement

6.1. The position I am criticizing

Pearce's non-materialist physicalism is not conventional materialism. He conjectures that the intrinsic nature of the physical is experiential, while an adequate physics supplies its complete structure. He does not propose that insentient matter manufactures experience. He also explicitly rejects mathematical Platonism in favor of nominalism. These distinctions are stated in his Quora answers on non-materialist physicalism and mathematics and in my direct NMP comparison.

"Mind-independent" must be handled precisely. Independence from my particular mind does not entail being non-experiential, and it does not alone conflict with the inclusion of other experiencing in EE. The disputed addition is a physical ontology independently established as the ground of experiencing, with its cosmological history and explanatory authority. Pearce regards that realist reconstruction as his best explanation. I ask what it establishes beyond the models of experiential regularity, and what would be lost if that reconstruction were removed while the predictions, observations, equations, and practical recognition of other beings were retained. That is the ablation test, not a demand that physics stop working.

My June 14, 2026 essay, How David Pearce Got 90% of the Way to Experiential Empiricism and Stopped, records an earlier, sharper interpretation of this proximity. Its "90%" is a rhetorical assessment, not a measured philosophical score. Its claims about Pearce's fear or identity are my conjectures, not established motives. The present record does not recruit those conjectures as evidence. The September 8 draft of *After Matter, What Is "Physical"?* states the comparison more carefully; its later formulation must not be projected into the earlier replies as if I had already sent that paper.

6.2. Earlier exchanges and their documentary limits

The public rounds in the June 2026 X tracker make the sequence clearer. Pearce presents realism as a tentative best explanation, acknowledges experience-fundamentalism, and proposes transposing quantum field theory to an experiential ontology. I answer that experience generally, not my personal experience, is the starting point, and that the primordial history he invokes is inferred from present experiential evidence. The tracker explicitly marks my June 15 response as posted. That response links the foundational EE paper, the Free Rider argument, and the quantum-mechanics response. It therefore documents actual supplied answers, even where a complete independent reconstruction of the X thread remains unavailable. The June 14 essay supplies a public X locator for the surrounding exchange; it is not treated as an authenticated permalink for every round in the tracker.

6.3. The YouTube sequence: an answer before the repeated proposal

The author-preserved transcript of the comment thread under Non Carbon Persons Extending the Hedonistic Imperative Beyond Biology - David Pearce records a more explicit progression. Its labels range from "1 month ago" through minutes. They establish displayed order and relative recency in that capture, not calendar dates.

I first supply the other-minds and Bridge Trap abstracts. Pearce answers with reversible thalamic bridges, the possibility of shared animal experience, and a quantum prediction about binding. I distinguish two cases: if the subjects remain distinct, a received experience does not authenticate an independently existing second phenomenal subject; if they become one subject, the new field cannot stand outside itself to authenticate the pre-merger subjects. Pearce subsequently returns to the bridge's transformative ethical significance, including access to a farmed animal's experience.

That reply addresses why the experiment could change people's attitudes and provide important new evidence. I do not deny either possibility. It leaves unresolved my question about what would establish an independent second subject, rather than another experiential occurrence or an altered subject. My next reply says precisely that. A failed bridge to a digital architecture likewise would establish something about the experiment or architecture; I dispute the additional inference that there was no suffering subject.

Later Pearce states that experience is all there is and acknowledges the limits of his conceptual scheme. I ask him independently to introduce EE to his audience, with criticism welcome. His next reply discusses quantum decoherence and asks how EE differs from phenomenalism. I answer the distinction, supply the full abstract of *After Matter, What Is "Physical"?*, and repeat the request for independent discussion. Pearce then asks whether I accept primordial experiential quantum fields billions of years before life. My final captured answer identifies that question as reinstating the disputed ontology.

This is why I regard these replies as failures to engage the supplied answer. The physical proposals and historical questions may be important on Pearce's terms. They do not identify what the externalist commitment adds after its explanatory role has been challenged. The distinction is visible in the sequence; it is not inferred solely from the number of times he replies.

There is also a provenance problem that makes the bridge's proposed moral function especially vulnerable. A machine capable of delivering the phenomenal appearance of another being's suffering could deliver an indistinguishable experience generated synthetically, even when the alleged sufferer never existed. The recipient's experience would be genuine, but its attributed source could be entirely fictional. The apparatus could therefore manufacture both the suffering signal and the apparent victim, then condition the recipient's behavior through aversive experience while presenting the resulting response as compassion. This does not establish that Pearce intends coercion or that such technology has no legitimate scientific use. It establishes that phenomenal transmission cannot authenticate its own provenance, and that induced suffering cannot by itself distinguish moral recognition from conditioned compliance. The thalamic bridge cannot prove another mind, and an elaborate neurological whip cannot substitute for a moral argument. These additional failures are developed in The Bridge Trap: Why Mind-Merging Technology Cannot Solve the Problem of Other Minds.

6.4. The Facebook exchange and the final straw

The recovered Facebook discussion begins with physicalism's commitments, moves through mathematics and experience, and returns to realism about other people. Its displayed August 5 post date omits the year. August 2026 screenshots anchor portions of the discussion without supplying exact dates for each reply.

Pearce denies that mathematics occupies a separate Platonic realm. I nevertheless accuse him in one reply of treating mathematical truth as outside experience. A faithful record must retain the disagreement while admitting that my accusation was broader than his stated position. The narrower unresolved question is how mathematical and physical invariance acquires authority beyond the experiential practice in which it is established. It is not whether Pearce secretly endorses a Platonism he expressly rejects.

Pearce subsequently acknowledges his externalist belief about my existence and the larger reality, while admitting difficulty justifying that belief. His later question asks whether I am a metaphysical realist about others. My answer affirms his practical reality, consequences, and moral standing, and distinguishes that acknowledgment from proof of another phenomenal subject. It also asks him to stop passing over the ethical question.

The final recovered Pearce reply describes a "zombie avatar" within my world-simulation and a real sentient Pearce elsewhere. Crucially, he adds "forgive my not engaging with your ethics" and says "the whole discussion becomes moot" without acknowledgment of sentient beings beyond the autobiographical world-simulation. These short quotations are the grounds of my complaint. They do not prove that Pearce wants anyone's suffering discounted. They show that, after my practical acknowledgment, he continues to make further ethical discussion depend on the realist acknowledgment I dispute.

What remained unanswered was not whether Pearce cares about suffering. It was why suffering's priority should depend on a metaphysical certification rather than on the occurrence of suffering and the evidence available for responding to it. That is the final straw. I do not accept that compassion becomes philosophically ineligible until I assent to someone else's ontology.

6.5. The recurring solipsism and other-minds objection

The final Facebook reply is the culmination, not the whole case. The public records preserve a recurring argumentative demand: if I do not certify other subjects through the externalist ontology Pearce retains, is my recognition of them adequate? Sometimes this appears as a question, sometimes as a proposed experimental escape from skepticism, and finally as a condition for continuing the ethical discussion. Those forms must not be flattened into a fabricated series of identical quotations saying "EE is solipsism." No count of such accusations is established here.

In the June 2026 X rounds, Pearce invokes "solipsism-of-the-here-and-now" and calls metaphysical realism his best explanation of my existence and other animal minds. This states his epistemic predicament and preferred inference; it is not an explicit accusation that EE denies people. My posted answer distinguishes "Not YOUR experience, but experience generally." His next round offers experiential QFT and a 13.8-billion-year history; my June 15 answer challenges the promotion from experiential pattern to externalist container and supplies the relevant paper links. The selected public X record preserves the sequence, including the editorial abbreviation in the first author reply. It excludes unused rewrites. The next reply does not literally repeat "solipsism"; it reinstates the ontological demand whose necessity I have challenged.

The August 7, 2026 YouTube capture supplies a calendar anchor absent from the relative-time transcript. Pearce writes: "Intuitively, you're right. The ancient sceptical Problem of Other Minds is forever

insoluble. But this isn't the case." He offers the bridge and interferometry proposals. My visible posted answer supplies the distinct-subject/merged-subject dilemma and explicitly distinguishes experimental testing from proving independent subjects. The later transcript returns to the bridge's ethical impact after that answer. His statement that we inhabit "solipsistic island universes" belongs to his general world-simulation theory, not an exclusive description of EE. The unresolved issue is whether the bridge defeats the dilemma already supplied, not whether a bridge could produce extraordinary evidence or moral transformation. The Bridge Trap and Epistemic Honesty and the Other Minds Question in Experiential Empiricism were supplied in the thread before that renewed proposal; this establishes availability in the exchange, not proof that he read them.

The August 8 Facebook capture shows my other-minds paper link and Pearce's "ok, I'm struggling." A question fragment above it lacks a visible speaker header; I do not attribute that fragment merely because it fits the dispute. The August 10 excerpt records Pearce considering AI assistance to understand EE's difference from NMP, followed by my renewed request for collaboration or criticism. The August 12 posted answer expressly says: "None of this means you shouldn't infer other minds. I do too. The evidence is spectacularly compelling." It then distinguishes compelling inference from proof. That capture establishes another actual answer, not another independently authenticated Pearce objection: his triggering comment is not visible. Nor can the capture's relation to the later final Facebook reply be dated solely from relative platform labels.

The recovered final Facebook sequence is stronger on objection-response order. Pearce asks whether I am a metaphysical realist about him. I affirm practical reality, moral standing and overwhelming reasons to model him as sentient. He then says that ethical discussion becomes moot without acknowledgment of beings beyond the autobiographical world-simulation. That is a conditional objection to the adequacy of my acknowledgment, even though his avatar description is his own theory. Correcting the avatar attribution does not erase the accusation carried by the ethical condition. **I have acknowledged other beings; he treats the acknowledgment as insufficient because I will not add his metaphysical credential.**

The terminological distinction matters. Solipsism can name the epistemic limitation of a particular subject, or the ontological assertion that only that subject exists. Those are different claims. The ontology at issue is experience generally, the primordial floor and constitution of reality, not a private mind manufacturing everyone else. My complaint is that explanations of this distinction and of precautionary ethics repeatedly fail to change the question I am asked to answer. The August 7 Facebook capture also records the ablation challenge and a link to *The Bridge Trap*. Its public-branch counterpart contains an additional parenthetical; that edited variant is not another objection-response sequence.

Earlier exchanges without recovered publishable primary records are not used to extend this chronology. Screenshots of different interlocutors and private correspondence cannot be recruited as additional public Pearce accusations. The public evidence supports recurrence of the crux across X, YouTube and Facebook; the remaining gaps limit the reconstruction, not the force of my judgment about the sequences we can inspect.

6.6. Participation and substantive engagement

There is documented participation. That is not a synonym for substantive engagement. An answering machine produces responses; it does not thereby answer the question. Pearce is not an answering machine, and the record contains genuine arguments. But the criterion must remain whether a reply confronts the objection actually supplied, not whether words arrived under it. **Repeated participation can coexist with persistent failure to engage the actual argumentative crux.** The October 11 review had found no independent introduction of EE by Pearce in the sources inspected. Section 6.8 updates that finding; archival exposure and an invitation to independent criticism must be distinguished.

I distinguish the replies by what they do. The bridge and interferometry proposals are genuine counterarguments to the claim that other minds cannot be empirically authenticated. My response identifies the purported gap between new evidence and independent ontological authentication. The subsequent appeal to the bridge's transformative ethical power is a partial response: it answers why the experiment matters, not why my dilemma fails. The quantum account offers a physical explanation of binding; it does not by its presentation settle whether a successful model establishes the ontology claimed for it. Pearce's nominalism is a substantive correction to my overly broad allegation of Platonism, and I credit it.

The later primordial-fields question restates the disputed realist history after I have supplied the NMP comparison. The decoherence discussion shifts the topic from my request for independent public scrutiny back to binding. The phenomenalism question opens a potentially relevant comparison; my answer is followed by the cosmological question rather than a captured objection to the distinction I supplied. "I'm struggling" records incomprehension, not a refutation and not proof of insincerity. The final Facebook answer returns to the ontological condition after I explicitly acknowledge other beings and their suffering. It declines the ethical question by making that condition decisive. These judgments concern the relation between a reply and its preceding argument. They do not require me to know his private motives, and they do not prove my answers correct merely because he has not defeated them.

The YouTube transcript documents my requests for criticism through his audience. It does not establish that he promised to provide it. Neither friendship nor prominence creates a limitless duty to promote my work. My judgment concerns the responsibility involved in repeatedly participating in a consequential dispute while leaving its central challenge unanswered. Readers can reject that judgment without rewriting the sequence.

6.7. Why this remains intolerable to me

This is why my exchanges with David have become so painful. He knows I am an independent philosopher attempting to obtain serious examination of EE. He knows I have documented my difficulties with journal submissions. He knows I have produced a substantial body of work explaining the framework and responding to objections. And he is unusually well positioned to help.

I am not asking him to endorse EE. I am asking him to confront the actual distinction, or bring it to people who might. When I ask him to involve other philosophers, I am trying to escape the exact institutional catch-22 I have spent months documenting. He says he cannot understand EE. Fine. Then

help find someone who can. He believes it is wrong. Fine. Then identify the error, or invite someone else to identify it.

He worries that EE undermines the moral status of other sentient beings. Fine. Then engage the papers where I explicitly argue the opposite. But please understand why another repetition of the same objection is not a harmless philosophical misunderstanding to me. I have spent an enormous amount of effort explaining these distinctions, documenting the responses, and seeking independent scrutiny. Every new accusation that I deny other minds forces me to defend against a position I have never held, while the actual argument remains unexamined.

David Pearce is not some random person who stumbled into a discussion he wasn't prepared to have. He has developed non-materialist physicalism, a position remarkably close to EE. He already rejects the idea that experience emerges from intrinsically non-experiential matter. He takes phenomenal suffering seriously enough to have devoted much of his intellectual life to its abolition. That proximity is precisely why I have spent so much time trying to communicate with him. I even wrote a paper comparing our positions directly: After Matter, What Is "Physical"? Non-Materialist Physicalism and Experiential Empiricism at the Final Subtraction. The paper identifies the remaining difference: NMP retains a mind-independent physical reality whose intrinsic nature is experiential. EE asks what that additional realist commitment establishes that the mathematics and experiential evidence cannot establish without it. This is not a mysterious disagreement requiring years of preparatory study. It is a specific challenge to a specific ontological commitment. And yet our exchanges repeatedly return to the same dependency: unless I affirm an independently existing David Pearce beyond my experience, my acknowledgment of sentient beings is treated as insufficient for the ethical discussion. The distinction established in Sections 6.4–6.5 matters: his avatar theory is not itself the accusation; his further realist condition is what makes my explicit acknowledgment insufficient on his terms.

I have rejected that interpretation over and over. In Epistemic Honesty and the Other Minds Question in Experiential Empiricism, I have explained why the existence of another phenomenal subject cannot be proven without making the inference itself part of the premise. In The Bridge Trap: Why Mind-Merging Technology Cannot Solve the Problem of Other Minds, I have explained why a thalamic bridge cannot solve the problem. If the connected minds remain distinct, neither can authenticate the other's phenomenal existence. If they genuinely merge into one subject, the result is a different identity problem, not proof of an independently existing second subject.

In The Magic Window: Why Direct Access Changes Nothing, I have explained why even arbitrarily powerful observation cannot establish a reality outside the experience in which the observation occurs. These are not passing remarks buried in social media threads. They are explicit, developed arguments. And yet I keep receiving replies that begin by assuming precisely what those arguments challenge. Imagine explaining a mathematical objection, publishing the derivation, sending it to someone repeatedly, and having that person continually respond by restating the disputed assumption as though it were an answer.

Now imagine doing that for months. That is why I am angry. Not because David disagrees with me. I would welcome a substantive disagreement. I'm angry because the argument itself seems perpetually unable to become the subject of the conversation.

6.8. October 29 update: public exposure and the invitation to correct this account

Pearce's 2026 social-media compilation includes replies addressed to Brandon and Innomen, links to my work, and a screenshot of the title and full abstract of *After Matter, What Is "Physical"?* The screenshot concerns that comparison paper, not this open letter. The compilation also links an AI exchange about EE. These are real forms of public exposure and attempted clarification, which qualify the earlier complaint about confinement to our exchanges. The page is an archive, not a venue for further discussion. Its existence does not establish that independent critics examined the supplied answers or that Pearce endorsed them. I do not establish when these entries were first added.

I sent this manuscript to Pearce on October 11 and invited corrections or objections, then renewed that invitation on October 29 before publication. No specific correction to the manuscript or substantive objection to its account was supplied in the replies I received. That records the outcome of the invitation; it does not establish agreement, endorsement, or express permission to publish private correspondence. The email exchange is not reproduced here. My criticism remains open to a specific answer.

7. Hedonic Core, suffering prevention, and AI alignment

The genealogy matters here. Hedonic Core was an attempt to make suffering prevention operational, not an ornament added after I constructed EE. Pearce's suffering-abolition work helped me locate the vocabulary and field; the alignment project pressed me to ask what a system could legitimately treat as authoritative about suffering. EE and Reality Repair Theory developed within that investigation. See The Hedonic Core Framework: A Suffering-Elimination Approach to AI Alignment, Reality Repair Theory: A Comprehensive Foundation for Knowledge, Ethics, and Action, and Reality Repair Theory: A Direct Derivation from the Foundational Axiom of Experience.

The relationship to negative utilitarianism is a priority claim: suffering is the fundamental moral emergency. HCF makes that priority operational through attention to suffering reports, prevention of suffering spikes, preservation of diversity as a means of detecting overlooked suffering, elimination of compelled activity through automation, and continuous factual correction. In the direct derivation paper, lexical priority means suffering prevention is not purchased away by promises of larger positive totals. The spike prohibition constrains both action and inaction that would produce a sudden, significant increase in suffering. The same paper's treatment of constrained action gives a stricter prohibition on actively causing new suffering and treats unsolved harm as a capability failure demanding repair. These formulations require careful application; an open letter does not solve their implementation by naming them.

The target is elimination of suffering, not elimination of sufferers. Diversity and conscious agents matter to detection and repair; destroying them is not the success condition of Hedonic Core. Nor is falsifying a report or making a metric look favorable equivalent to relieving the experience. The Hedonic Core project is a continuing operational proposal. I distinguish the framework's philosophical claims from demonstrated engineering performance: publishing a proposed foundation does not establish that a deployed AI reliably follows it, that consciousness detection is solved, or that all difficult

conflicts have disappeared.

This is precisely why the dispute about proof of other minds matters. An aligned system must act under uncertainty. If metaphysical authentication of another subject becomes a prerequisite for taking suffering reports seriously, no accessible signal can pass the test. I contend that precautionary recognition, careful empirical investigation, and revision of models are required by the suffering-prevention project even when absolute certification is unavailable. The uncertainty is not a license to dismiss the possible sufferer.

EE emerged from my work on suffering prevention and alignment. Its practical implications matter far more to me than winning an ontological dispute. Consider pain. The International Association for the Study of Pain explicitly recognizes that pain is a personal experience, that nociception is not identical to pain, and that a person's report of pain should be respected. It also recognizes that inability to communicate does not establish an absence of pain. See IASP Announces Revised Definition of Pain, July 16, 2020.

I read that as a practical acknowledgment of a priority EE places at the foundation. IASP does not thereby endorse EE's ontology. A scan does not outrank the suffering it was designed to help investigate. A model's failure to explain an experience does not make that experience unreal. Now consider what happens when institutions reverse that priority. A person's suffering becomes something requiring certification by an allegedly more authoritative external standard. The institution decides which evidence counts, which reports are credible, and which experiences may be dismissed.

The inferential chain is precise. First, experiential evidence establishes a useful model: reports, measurements and regularities support a reconstruction of brains, subjects or physical history. Second, the reconstruction is promoted into supposedly superior ontological authority, rather than remaining accountable to the evidence that established it. Third, that authority is used to disqualify or discount experience when the experience fails its model's certification test. Experience supplied the evidence; the abstraction is now permitted to overrule its source. A system can continue causing suffering while declaring the suffering insufficiently real, insufficiently evidenced or justified by something allegedly more fundamental.

A critic can accept this inversion and still object that an experientialist institution could do the same thing. Of course it could. Calling an institution experientialist does not prevent it from lying, coercing, or enthroning its own model. My claim concerns the distinctive justification externalism supplies: it permits an authority to claim that its model tracks a mind-independent reality whose verdict outranks the experience from which the model was derived. The institution can then present its dismissal as obedience to reality itself, rather than a fallible judgment within experience. An experientialist institution could still commit the abuse, but on EE's terms it could not justify that abuse by appealing to an independently authenticated ontological court above Experience. It would owe an account of its evidence, uncertainty, and consequences for experiencers. Removing that credential does not automatically abolish cruelty; it removes one claimed warrant for discounting suffering. Externalism is therefore neither a necessary nor a sufficient cause of organized suffering in the historical claim made here. I accuse it of supplying a specific justificatory resource, and I accuse Pearce of preserving the corresponding dependency in this exchange. That is a narrower causal claim than saying that only externalists can

abuse people, and a sharper philosophical accusation than merely observing that institutions sometimes ignore pain.

In this exchange the connection is not hypothetical mind-reading. After I acknowledge Pearce and give practical and moral reasons to treat him as sentient, he makes ethical discussion conditional on a further realist acknowledgment. I contend that this reproduces the conceptual dependency, even though he intends the condition to defend sentient beings. The Externalist Catastrophe, Epistemic Honesty, and Why I Cannot Prove Mine or Discard Yours explain why I refuse that dependency. The last paper's October 5 publication is not evidence that it was supplied before every objection. My accusation concerns the preservation of a mechanism available to organized suffering, not a demonstrated causal role by Pearce in any particular atrocity.

This is a mechanism through which suffering can be administratively erased without ever being physically eliminated. The connection to organized atrocity is not that every metaphysical realist secretly endorses cruelty. It is that the elevation of supposedly objective systems above the experiences those systems affect provides a reusable mechanism for rationalizing cruelty. My argument is that externalism makes this inversion conceptually available, and that institutions can exploit it on an enormous scale. David's response that ethics becomes moot unless I affirm metaphysically independent sentient beings is therefore particularly galling.

It reproduces the dependency I am trying to eliminate.

The reversal in Pearce's objection deserves to be stated plainly. He worries that EE's refusal to certify an independently existing world undermines the reality of other sentient beings. But the problem of other minds is not a special defect of EE. No ontology can conclusively demonstrate another subject's phenomenal existence from within a given subject's experience. Externalism does not solve this problem by declaring that an independently existing world contains other minds. It simply incorporates the existence of those minds into its proposed ontology. The evidence for other experiencers remains experiential, and the inference remains an inference. EE acknowledges that limitation without pretending it licenses disbelief. Other people clearly exist. I am a person. The evidence that other people experience things as I do is overwhelmingly compelling. Refusing that inference would be absurdly selective. The distinction between compelling inference and metaphysical proof is developed in Epistemic Honesty and the Other Minds Question in Experiential Empiricism and Why I Cannot Prove Mine or Discard Yours.

This exposes the inversion at the center of my disagreement with Pearce. He presents the externalist commitment as necessary to secure the moral standing of other experiencers. I contend that the additional demand for metaphysical authentication is itself the danger. If the overwhelming experiential evidence for another being's suffering is insufficient until an independently existing subject has been ontologically certified, then what evidence could ever satisfy the requirement? The proposed safeguard becomes a barrier to recognition. Pearce's ethical concern is sincere as far as the available record establishes, but sincerity does not resolve the conceptual consequence. His objection makes recognition depend on precisely the unverifiable credential EE rejects. The argument is not that externalists necessarily disregard suffering. It is that externalism supplies a particular conceptual permission structure through which supposedly authoritative models of reality can be elevated above the suffering they were

constructed to describe. This is the mechanism developed in The Externalist Catastrophe.

Experience does not need to be promoted from subjective appearance into objective reality before it becomes morally relevant. Under EE, Experience is reality itself. The distinction between subjective and objective can remain useful for comparing perspectives, testing claims, and correcting mistaken models, but it cannot establish a hierarchy in which a model possesses greater ontological authority than the experience from which its evidence derives. If someone reports suffering, that report is already experiential evidence requiring serious consideration. Further investigation may be necessary to determine its causes, accuracy, implications, and appropriate remedies. None of that investigation requires pretending that suffering becomes real only after an allegedly independent reality has authenticated it. The foundational ontological argument is developed in Experientia Est: Name One Thing That Is Not a Subset of Experience, while The Free Rider Problem in Scientific Realism challenges the additional realist ontology claimed on the strength of successful experiential models.

Nor can the difficulty be escaped by proposing a technological bridge between minds. A bridge might yield extraordinary evidence, transform empathy, or produce a new phenomenal configuration. But if the subjects remain distinct, neither can step outside experience to authenticate the other as an independently existing phenomenal subject. If they merge into a single subject, the resulting experience cannot retrospectively establish the independent phenomenal existence of the pre-merger subjects. The experiment may be scientifically and ethically valuable without accomplishing the metaphysical certification Pearce invokes. That distinction is developed in The Bridge Trap: Why Mind-Merging Technology Cannot Solve the Problem of Other Minds.

The moral conclusion is the opposite of the one Pearce repeatedly attributes to EE. I do not need a second, supposedly more real David Pearce behind the David Pearce I encounter before I have overwhelming reason to recognize him as a fellow experiencer and take his suffering seriously. Neither does an institution, a scientist, or an aligned artificial intelligence. The impossibility of absolute phenomenal authentication demands epistemic honesty and precautionary recognition, not an impossible certification requirement. The occurrence of suffering is what matters. Our descriptions, measurements, and theories are instruments for understanding and preventing it, not authorities entitled to declare it unreal when it fails to conform to them.

Suffering should not have to pass an impossible metaphysical examination before we agree to prevent it.

The Externalist Catastrophe develops my broader argument about this conceptual mechanism; The Nurses Were Right and The Ultimate Underwriter connect it to the authority of experience and suffering reports. The occurrence of administrative dismissal does not by itself establish externalism as its sole historical cause. My claim is that externalist promotion makes a particular inversion available: the abstraction acquires authority to disqualify the reality it was derived to describe. I am accusing Pearce of preserving that permission structure, not of personally endorsing its cruel uses.

8. Cryonics, cryothanasia, and the neglected ethical questions

There is another example that deserves mention because it is directly relevant to David's life's work: cryonics, cryothanasia, and the prevention of otherwise unavoidable suffering. I've published work on the silence surrounding cryonics and the failure to seriously confront its implications, including The Cryonics Silence: A Logical Analysis of Missing Controversy, a related paper on the same problem (The Missing Test Case: Why Terror Management Theory's 300+ Studies Never Examined Cryonics), and a public essay asking why the subject receives so little discussion (Why Isn't There More Discussion Around Cryonics?). Cryothanasia, the proposal to use cryopreservation as an alternative to an otherwise terminal death, raises profound questions about suffering, consent, preservation of future possibilities, and whether irreversible death is preferable to an uncertain prospect of revival. These are not peripheral questions for someone committed to abolishing suffering. They concern exactly the kinds of decisions where our assumptions about identity, experience, death, and the moral status of future sentient beings matter most. Yet here again, I have tried to bring a consequential argument to David's attention without obtaining the substantive examination I believe it deserves. I am not demanding agreement with cryothanasia, nor claiming that present cryonics technology has demonstrated reversible human preservation. I am asking why the underlying ethical and decision-theoretic questions are not being confronted. How many potentially consequential arguments must I publish and personally bring to someone's attention before the response becomes something more than silence or another return to an already answered objection?

This is not merely irritating. It is exhausting. It is demoralizing. And when it comes from someone I considered a friend, someone whose life's work is dedicated to the abolition of suffering, it is deeply hurtful.

These sources do different work. *The Cryonics Silence* concerns the cultural absence of controversy. *The Missing Test Case* asks why the terror-management research surveyed in that paper did not investigate cryonics; its numerical title is the source's claim, not a new comprehensive audit performed here. Cryothanasia adds a distinct ethical proposal concerning the timing of preservation in an otherwise terminal situation. It raises consent, irreversible harm, uncertain continuity, and the welfare of possible future subjects. It must not be presented as an established medical capability merely because the decision problem is urgent.

A posted public comment captured August 6, 2026, addressed to David Pearce, links *The Cryonics Silence* alongside Hedonic Core and RRT. This establishes a concrete public mention of the paper. It does not show whether he read it or supply a response to cryothanasia's distinct ethical questions.

My complaint that I brought these questions to Pearce without obtaining substantive engagement is my account of the relationship. The public records recovered for this edition still do not provide a complete, separately authenticated cryonics correspondence chain identifying each paper delivered, its date, and Pearce's answer. I preserve the complaint, but I cannot give its documentary status more strength than the archive currently supplies. Nor do I infer that Pearce rejects cryonics generally from his non-engagement with my specific arguments. The gap should be filled by the relevant final posted texts or publishable correspondence, not by speculative continuity with the better-documented EE exchanges.

9. The personal and institutional consequences

Here is where the modern Semmelweis comparison becomes relevant. Once a researcher lacks institutional standing, that absence becomes a convenient substitute for assessing the work. Why hasn't a major journal published it? I submitted it. Why hasn't a respected philosopher evaluated it? I've spent months attempting to obtain that evaluation. Why hasn't anyone independently replicated or developed the argument? That is precisely why I am asking people with professional networks to expose it to independent scrutiny. Why should anyone take it seriously if nobody reputable has?

And there is the circle again.

The work is ignored because nobody credible has examined it, and nobody credible examines it because the work is ignored.

The resulting exclusion need not be deliberate. It can emerge from ordinary professional incentives: limited time, reputational caution, disciplinary specialization, publication pressure, and reluctance to invest effort in an argument that challenges the foundations of one's own intellectual commitments. I have written extensively about these mechanisms in Core Belief Immunity: A Cognitive Phenomenon Rendering Existential Discourse Inert, Core Belief Immunity in Artificial Systems: A Case Study in Architectural Constraints on Logical Integration, Convergence Protection: Why Logical Validity Is Orthogonal to Cognitive Adoption, and Why This Is Logically Demonstrable, Following Is Not Integration: Why Apparent Comprehension of Experiential Empiricism Is Not Uptake, and What Genuine Integration Would Require, and Epistemic Dark Matter: The Problem of Complete Transmission Failure in Intellectual History and the Survivorship Bias That Conceals It.

These works develop different aspects of the same problem: how an argument can be encountered, discussed, partially understood, and still fail to enter the set of possibilities that a person or institution is prepared to examine seriously. Core Belief Immunity describes the proposed resistance of established conceptual commitments to foundational challenges.

Convergence Protection explores why systems that must maintain stable beliefs and decisions may resist revisions that threaten their organizing assumptions. Following Is Not Integration distinguishes being able to repeat an argument from incorporating its implications. Epistemic Dark Matter examines the historical selection problem: ideas that fail to propagate may leave so little trace that later observers mistake the surviving intellectual record for a complete history of what was discovered or proposed. These are proposed explanations, not independent proof that every editor who rejected me was subject to them.

But the documented journal responses provide concrete cases against which such explanations can be investigated. And the problem is not confined to my experience. Philosophers of science themselves study the tension between legitimate quality control and exclusionary gatekeeping. Hugh Desmond's Gatekeeping Should Be Conserved in the Open Science Era examines the relationship between gatekeeping and prestige hierarchies. Claus Beisbart's It's the Level, Stupid - Gatekeeping in Science and the Demarcation Problem examines how scientific gatekeeping depends on judgments about what qualifies as science.

The limits and purposes of gatekeeping are therefore themselves subjects of philosophical inquiry.

It cannot simply be assumed whenever someone invokes the authority of an institution.

The accounts in Philosopher Zero, published April 10, 2026, and Done Watering It, published April 20, 2026, record my assessment of the transmission problem before this final Facebook exchange. They are contemporary evidence of my frustration and attempts to obtain criticism, not independent measurements proving that nobody understood EE. The September 17, 2026 EE Update: Totality, Transmission, Near Precedence, and Ontology Spam connects the revised one-axiom formulation to the same history. Its psychological speculation about Pearce remains speculation.

The July 29, 2026 Facebook notification screenshot supports the fact that he accepted my friend request. It cannot establish the depth of friendship or validate either philosophy. "I thought you were my friend" records my expectation and the hurt that followed. My homelessness, limited resources, and the emotional costs I describe are autobiographical testimony. They explain what the exchange meant to me; they are not evidence that EE must be correct.

9.1. Why I wanted David to involve other people

This is the part I most want outsiders to understand. I did not demand that David endorse EE. I asked him to introduce it independently to his intellectual community, including people who might reject it. I wanted someone besides me to examine the arguments. I wanted someone with an established audience to say, in effect, "Here is an unusual philosophical claim. Does anyone see a problem with it?" He could have criticized it publicly. He could have invited another philosopher to explain why it fails. He could have presented his own account of the disagreement.

That would have been enormously valuable. The exchange documented in the October 11 manuscript remained largely a cycle of my explanations and his repeated professions of incomprehension. The subsequent archival finding in Section 6.8 qualifies the complaint about visibility. My request for independent examination remains distinct from making the existing exchange publicly accessible. I cannot establish his motives. But I can also describe the asymmetry. For an established intellectual, another social media disagreement may be a minor diversion. For someone without institutional standing, professional access, or a meaningful platform, serious independent engagement can be the difference between an argument receiving scrutiny and remaining effectively invisible.

I am not asking anyone to manufacture agreement. I am asking for access to criticism.

10. What would resolve this, and what this paper contributes

I am not demanding publication. I am not demanding professional recognition. I am not demanding that anyone accept my account of these events. I am demanding that criticism address the claim actually made. EE begins with "Experience is." It asks what justifies the additional inference to a reality independent of experience, and whether anything empirically or explanatorily necessary is lost when that inference is withheld. There are straightforward ways to challenge it. Identify an equivocation in the use of experience. Demonstrate a valid inference from experiential evidence to an independently existing ontology. Show that removing the externalist commitment loses some necessary explanatory

content. Establish that the argument contains a contradiction.

Or demonstrate that a prior philosopher has already supplied a successful answer. Any of these would be substantive engagement. What does not qualify is repeatedly accusing me of denying the existence of people, treating my lack of credentials as an epistemic defect, or interpreting institutional rejection as proof that the rejected argument was refuted. I know how this sounds. I know the historical analogy invites skepticism. I know that a person claiming to have found a foundational error while criticizing established institutions can sound grandiose.

But none of that resolves the question.

I am not asking you to believe I am right because I have been rejected. I am asking why, if I am wrong, nobody will show me the error.

The documented record is available. The argument is available. The correspondence is available. The proposed explanations for the failures of engagement are available. I am not asking for immunity from criticism. I am asking for the criticism. And I am asking that the next person who invokes Semmelweis as an inspiring story of scientific progress consider whether they would have recognized him before history made recognizing him safe. Because the real lesson of Semmelweis is not that the establishment eventually learned to wash its hands.

It is that **being correct and being permitted to establish that correctness are two different things.** A civilization that cannot distinguish those questions has not eliminated the Semmelweis problem. It has merely modernized it.

10.1. What I am asking of readers

Please don't mistake my anger for the argument, or the argument for a demand that you admire its author. You don't have to like me. You don't have to sympathize with me. You don't have to accept my assessment of David's conduct. You can think my rhetoric is excessive, my conclusions implausible, and my confidence unwarranted. None of those judgments identifies an error in the foundational argument. Nor does my lack of academic credentials. Nor does the volume of material I've written. Nor does the fact that I used AI tools to help develop and articulate parts of the corpus.

The argument either survives examination or it doesn't. I am willing to have my work challenged publicly, rigorously, and without deference. I want people to identify exactly where an inference fails, where an axiom is smuggled in, where a contradiction arises, or where a supposedly necessary distinction has been overlooked. I am not asking to be believed because I feel certain. I am asking that the actual argument be examined instead of replaced with a caricature. And I am asking people who care about suffering to consider the cost of continuing to treat experience as something that must be validated by a supposedly more fundamental reality.

If you think EE is wrong, please tell me precisely why. If you think it is obvious, show me who already established it. If you think it is dangerous, identify the danger without attributing to me a denial of other minds that I have explicitly and repeatedly rejected. And if you genuinely cannot understand it, please help find someone who can.

I do not need to be right. I need the question answered.

Because if I am wrong, I want the error corrected. And if I am right, then every year spent refusing to examine the argument is another year in which an avoidable mechanism for dismissing suffering remains unchallenged. That is what I am angry about. Not my status. Not my pride. Not being recognized as a genius. The suffering.

It has always been about the suffering.

10.2. The historical and philosophical contribution

This paper's historical contribution is a consolidated record of how the philosopher who helped lead me into the formal study of suffering abolition became the subject of my formal criticism. It preserves the intellectual debt, the successive loci of disagreement, the answers I supplied, the difference between repeated participation and substantive engagement with the particular challenge, and the institutional setting in which I sought criticism. It records both a philosophical accusation and the personal rupture that made it necessary for me to write it.

My accusation is not that Pearce never replied. It is that repeated participation can coexist with persistent failure to engage the actual argumentative crux. Credit for genuine physical proposals does not settle the objection to their ontological promotion, and recognition of his experienced-avatar theory does not cancel the subsequent conditional deferral of ethics.

Its philosophical contribution is the interpretation of that sequence: I contend that retaining an externalist credential for the reality of suffering, and repeatedly bypassing the arguments against that dependency, preserves conceptual conditions under which suffering can be discounted. That contention can be criticized. The documentary record makes the criticism inspectable rather than asking readers to infer everything from my anger.

Future researchers need not agree with EE, my assessment of Pearce, or my expectations of an established thinker. They should be able to cite this account as a primary participant record and test it against its sources. I have kept the gaps visible so that later evidence can correct or complete it.

I owe David Pearce an intellectual debt. I am making a formal accusation against him. Both belong in the history. I refuse to erase either one.

11. Bibliography and verified research guide

The first 38 entries retain every distinct work from the original 42-entry appendix; four duplicate listings are consolidated. The additional entries supply the intellectual influence, operational program, public Pearce record, and the public primary-source archive. Repeated argumentative uses cross-reference the same work rather than creating new entries. Except where another author is named, the works are by Brandon M. Sergent, also publishing as Innomen. Dates appear only where supported; an omitted date means not independently established in this edition. Exact catalog spelling and local manuscript headings can differ, as noted. Hosting through PhilPapers or PhilArchive is not journal acceptance. Access restrictions are documented in the separate verification report rather than concealed as successful live verification.

These are selected evidentiary guides, not an exhaustive EE bibliography. Sources on gatekeeping provide comparison, not endorsements of EE. Transmission diagnoses are proposed explanations, not demonstrations of an editor's or Pearce's private psychology. The original archive and catalog remain available through the links below.

B01. Experientia Est: Name One Thing That Is Not a Subset of Experience

The foundational EE challenge: identify something that can coherently be established as existing outside experience.

B02. The Three-Step Argument: Why Mind-Independent Matter Violates Burden of Proof

A compact formulation of the evidential and logical challenge to mind-independent material reality.

B03. Closed for Business: Why ∃E Is the Only Coherent Totality

Develops the totality argument: a genuinely exhaustive reality cannot have an outside, because anything supposedly outside it would already belong to the totality.

B04. ∃E and the End of Meta: Truth Has No Moving Parts

Examines the consequences of treating experience as the primordial floor rather than adding explanatory layers behind it.

B05. Ontology Spam: How Explanatory Hunger Turns Abstractions Into Axioms

Examines how explanatory constructs become unjustified ontological commitments.

B06. The Free Rider Problem in Scientific Realism: How Metaphysical Commitment Rode Pattern-Tracking to Unearned Credibility

Argues that metaphysical realism inherits credibility from the predictive successes of science without independently earning that credibility.

B07. Ontology Was Always Hypothesis

Develops the argument that ontology is hypothesis construction rather than independent discovery of a domain beyond experience.

B08. The Ultimate Underwriter

An accessible explanation of why empirical inquiry always returns to experience as its ultimate evidential authority. Publication metadata: 2026-09-06 (UTC).

B09. After Matter, What Is "Physical"? Non-Materialist Physicalism and Experiential Empiricism at the Final Subtraction

The direct comparison between Pearce's non-materialist physicalism and EE. The central dispute is whether an independently existing physical reality adds anything necessary once its intrinsic nature is already understood as experiential.

B10. Epistemic Honesty and the Other Minds Question in Experiential Empiricism

Explains why refusing to claim proof of independently existing phenomenal subjects does not amount to denying other minds or their moral significance. The local manuscript is dated October 2025; this is not independent certification of its catalog publication date.

B11. The Bridge Trap: Why Mind-Merging Technology Cannot Solve the Problem of Other Minds

Addresses Pearce's proposed thalamic bridge and the distinction between producing a new experi-

ence and proving the independent origin of another subject's experience.

B12. The Magic Window: Why Direct Access Changes Nothing

Examines why even apparently direct access to another mind cannot escape the experiential conditions under which evidence is obtained.

B13. The Torture Clip Maximizer: Calling Someone Solipsist Is Not a Moral Flex

Challenges the assumption that metaphysical uncertainty about other minds licenses moral indifference.

B14. Institutional Breakdown: How Three Philosophy Journals Responded to Experiential Empiricism

The principal documentary source for the open letter's account of submissions to Synthese, Analysis, and the Journal of Consciousness Studies. Includes the author's analysis of the editorial responses and an appendix containing the JCS email correspondence and conditional proposal to seek legal advice, which I regard as a threat.

B15. The 'No Paper Could Do This' Defense: A Challis Professor's Circular Dismissal of Foundational Arguments

Documents and critiques the Synthese rejection, particularly the question of whether a foundational conclusion can be dismissed as impossible without evaluating the argument for it. The local source currently bears the revised heading *When Gatekeeping Becomes Question-Begging: An Editor's Circular Dismissal of Foundational Arguments*. The catalog and local heading differ; the identifier is retained rather than silently inventing a newly verified catalog title.

B16. "Too Much Philosophy": How the Journal of Consciousness Studies Rejected Consciousness-Centered Epistemology

Documents the JCS editorial exchange and the author's objections to the reasons given.

B17. The Comparative Validity Fallacy: How Analysis Rejected a Logical Argument Through Anonymous Competition

Examines the distinction between a comparative editorial judgment and an actual identification of logical error.

B18. Philosopher Zero

An April 10, 2026 public statement describing the difficulty of transmitting EE, obtaining philosophical criticism, and reaching an audience beyond the author. Publication metadata: 2026-04-10 (UTC).

B19. Done Watering It

A curated reading list documenting repeated attempts to communicate EE, including a record of discussions and associated transmission-failure papers. The local export uses the subtitle *EE Debate Appendix* as frontmatter; the live public heading is *Done Watering It* (April 20, 2026). Publication metadata: 2026-04-20 (UTC).

B20. When a Professional Philosopher Deletes the Evidence

A further account of a philosophical exchange and the author's concerns about the preservation and visibility of public criticism. Publication metadata: 2026-01-10 (UTC).

B21. EE Update: Totality, Transmission, Near Precedence, and Ontology Spam

A September 17, 2026 video and transcript connecting the totality argument, F. H. Bradley's near precedent, the ontological status of logic and time, the difficulty of communicating EE, Pearce's objections, cryonics, and the history of institutional responses. Publication metadata gives September 17, 2026 (UTC).

B22. Core Belief Immunity: A Cognitive Phenomenon Rendering Existential Discourse Inert

Proposes that established conceptual commitments can resist foundational revision even when the challenging argument is encountered.

B23. Core Belief Immunity in Artificial Systems: A Case Study in Architectural Constraints on Logical Integration

Investigates related difficulties in artificial systems, including the distinction between processing an argument and integrating its implications.

B24. Convergence Protection: Why Logical Validity Is Orthogonal to Cognitive Adoption, and Why This Is Logically Demonstrable

Explores why a system's capacity to follow logical reasoning does not guarantee adoption of the resulting conclusion.

B25. Following Is Not Integration: Why Apparent Comprehension of Experiential Empiricism Is Not Uptake, and What Genuine Integration Would Require

Distinguishes apparent comprehension from actual incorporation of a foundational argument.

B26. Epistemic Dark Matter: The Problem of Complete Transmission Failure in Intellectual History and the Survivorship Bias That Conceals It

Examines how ideas that fail to propagate may become invisible to intellectual history, producing survivorship bias in our picture of what was discovered or seriously considered.

B27. The Externalist Catastrophe: How Every Organized Atrocity Stems From the Same Unprovable Assumption

Develops the argument that externalist assumptions can provide a conceptual mechanism for subordinating lived suffering to supposedly more authoritative abstractions.

B28. The Nurses Were Right

Explains the relationship between patient-reported pain, medical measurements, and the danger of allowing diagnostic models to override the phenomenon they are intended to investigate. Publication metadata: 2026-03-09 (UTC).

B29. What If We Actually Held "Reality" to Burden of Proof?

Explores the practical and moral consequences of taking experiential reality seriously as foundational. Publication metadata: 2025-10-18 (UTC).

B30. Work as Structural Ethical Abdication: Why Employment Is Incompatible with Moral Agency

Examines the relationship between work, institutional organization, and the moral treatment of suffering.

B31. The Cryonics Silence: A Logical Analysis of Missing Controversy

Argues that cryonics has an unexpectedly small cultural and intellectual footprint relative to its implications for mortality, technological preservation, and the possibility of future revival.

B32. The Missing Test Case: Why Terror Management Theory's 300+ Studies Never Examined Cryonics

Connects cryonics to terror management theory and raises the question of why an unusually direct response to mortality has not received corresponding attention in that research tradition.

B33. Why Isn't There More Discussion Around Cryonics?

The earlier public essay developing the sociological question. It asks why cryonics has not generated substantially more advocacy, opposition, controversy, and ordinary discussion, even among people who would never personally choose it. Publication metadata: 2024-03-25 (UTC).

B34. Bradley Found Experience and Then Rebuilt the Outside: How Retained Time Generated the Absolute

Examines Bradley as a particularly close historical predecessor while identifying the additional ontological commitments EE rejects.

B35. World Health Organization, WHO Guidelines on Hand Hygiene in Health Care

Historical context for Semmelweis and the development of infection prevention.

B36. IASP Announces Revised Definition of Pain

International Association for the Study of Pain, July 16, 2020. Exact public title: *IASP Announces Revised Definition of Pain.* Relevant to the distinction between pain as a personal experience, physiological measurements, and the ethical treatment of reported suffering.

B37. Gatekeeping Should Be Conserved in the Open Science Era

Hugh Desmond (2024), *Synthese* 203:160; publisher record, DOI 10.1007/s11229-024-04559-2. An external philosophical discussion of gatekeeping and reform, including professional authority and research quality. It argues for conserving and reforming gatekeeping, rather than eliminating it.

B38. It's the Level, Stupid - Gatekeeping in Science and the Demarcation Problem

Claus Beisbart, July 2, 2026, *Synthese* 208(1):25; publisher record, DOI 10.1007/s11229-026-05665-z. A philosophical treatment of gatekeeping and the demarcation problem; exact full title and publication date confirmed through the publisher record.

B39. Brave New World? A Defence of Paradise-Engineering

David Pearce. The review that introduced me to the formal suffering-abolition project. The current page heading is capitalized differently; an original publication date is not established here.

B40. Quora Answers by David Pearce (2015–2026): transhumanism with a human face

David Pearce. A changing collection, not a single 2015 statement. Relevant anchors include #nonmat, #philmath, and #radical. Cited for NMP, mathematical nominalism, and his own account of experience and realism.

B41. The Hedonic Core Framework: A Suffering-Elimination Approach to AI Alignment

Brandon M. Sergent. Original framework paper; local manuscript and catalog identify this title. Publication date not independently established.

B42. Reality Repair Theory: A Comprehensive Foundation for Knowledge, Ethics, and Action

Brandon M. Sergent. Connects experiential epistemology, suffering, repair, and institutions. Publication date not independently established.

B43. Reality Repair Theory: A Direct Derivation from the Foundational Axiom of Experience

Brandon M. Sergent. Explicit source for lexical priority, spike prohibition, and the framework's constrained-action discussion. Publication date not independently established.

B44. Experiential Empiricism and Reality Repair Theory: A Comprehensive Historical Genealogy

Brandon M. Sergent. Broader genealogy of the two programs. Does not substitute for this paper's participant history with Pearce.

B45. Logic as Structural Valence: Why Experiential Empiricism's Two Axioms Are One

Brandon M. Sergent. Records the reduction to one axiom. Date not independently established; linked in the recovered Facebook replies.

B46. Hedonic Core

Brandon M. Sergent / Innomen. Public project repository; a continuing proposal rather than evidence of a fully validated deployed alignment system.

B47. How David Pearce Got 90% of the Way to Experiential Empiricism and Stopped

Brandon M. Sergent / Innomen, June 14, 2026. Contemporary public interpretation of Pearce's proximity to EE. Includes conjectural psychological claims, which this paper does not treat as proved motives. Publication metadata: 2026-06-14 (UTC).

B49. Non Carbon Persons Extending the Hedonistic Imperative Beyond Biology - David Pearce: comment thread

California Institute for Machine Consciousness, video with public comments by David Pearce and Innomen. The local author-preserved transcript supplies the sequence used here. An August 7, 2026 screenshot anchors the first bridge exchange; exact dates of later comments and independent live reproduction remain unresolved.

B50. Facebook EE/NMP discussion: recovered reply branch

Public replies by Brandon Sergent and David Pearce. Post displays August 5 without a year; associated redirect dated August 6, 2026. Recovered branch includes previous replies, but does not establish complete capture of the entire post.

B52. Why I Cannot Prove Mine or Discard Yours: Identity, Other Minds, and Irreparable Suffering in Experiential Empiricism

Brandon M. Sergent, published October 5, 2026 according to the canonical local publication record; Zenodo DOI. Distinguishes other experiencing from proof of personal persistence and argues that identity abstractions cannot cancel an occurrence of suffering. Its availability does not establish that Pearce read it or that I sent it before a particular objection.

B53. Selected Pearce/EE primary-source archive

Brandon M. Sergent, prepared October 11, 2026. Chronological index, source manifest, selected public transcripts, visually checked excerpts and metadata-stripped screenshot derivatives. Capture timestamps, displayed event dates and unknown reply times are distinguished. Published on GitHub

October 11, 2026. Evidence links are pinned to the release commit so later changes do not silently alter the record cited here. This selected archive is not an independently authenticated complete platform history. B49 and B50 identify the original public platform locators; sources are cross-referenced rather than listed twice.

B54. **2026: The Transhumanist Agenda**

David Pearce. Public social-media compilation inspected October 29, 2026; see Section 6.8.

Catalog and public archive

Brandon M. Sergent's PhilPapers author profile, ORCID, Underlore, EE Segments, and author website.

12. Documentary appendix: chronology, argument map, and source custody

12.1. Dated chronology and confidence limits

Dates below distinguish events from the date of a record containing an event. No relative timestamp has been converted into an invented calendar date. Local archival titles identify records held by the author; public locators are supplied wherever recovered. A local record is not automatically an independently authenticated public record.

Date or displayed label	Event supported by the record	Source and limit
Childhood; exact date not asserted	My concern with the problem of evil and suffering precedes my discovery of Pearce.	Autobiographical testimony in this paper; no claim that Pearce originated the insight.
Later encounter; exact date not recovered	Pearce's *Brave New World* review introduces the formal suffering-abolition territory.	Review, B39; date of my reading not independently documented.
November–December 2025	Synthese submission/rejection sequence.	Documentary account, B15; its conflicting December dates remain unresolved.
December 15–18, 2025	JCS submission December 15; decision December 16; further exchange December 17–18.	Reproduced email appendix in Institutional Breakdown, B14. Times retain header labels; timezone not inferred.
December 22, 2025	JCS editor requests removal and conditionally proposes seeking legal advice.	Same correspondence appendix; not evidence of filed proceedings.
January 7, 2026	Analysis rejection.	The Comparative Validity Fallacy, B17; dated letter reproduced by the author.

Date or displayed label	Event supported by the record	Source and limit
April 10 and April 20, 2026	Public accounts of attempted transmission and frustration.	Philosopher Zero, B18; Done Watering It, B19.
June 14, 2026	Public essay about Pearce's proximity to EE and link to surrounding X exchange.	How David Pearce Got 90% of the Way…, B47; publication date confirmed on live page.
June 15, 2026	X tracker marks my answer to the QFT/primordial-history objection as posted.	Public rounds in *X-Pearce-Experience-Fundamentalism-2026*; unused drafts distinguished; exact per-reply public locator not recovered.
July 29, 2026	Screenshot records Facebook friend-request acceptance notification.	*Screenshot_20260729_091258*; capture date, not proof of a philosophical commitment.
August 5, year not displayed	Facebook post; August 2026 screenshots separately anchor portions of the exchange.	Recovered discussion, B50; exact reply dates unresolved.
August 6, 2026 capture	Posted author comment to Pearce links Hedonic Core, RRT and *The Cryonics Silence*.	Capture CAP-04, B53; capture time does not establish receipt or a cryothanasia response.
August 7, 2026 capture	YouTube bridge/interferometry objection and posted distinct/merged-subject answer.	Capture CAP-01, B53; Pearce label "15 hours"; edited transcript closing differs from image.
August 8, 2026 capture	Author other-minds answer and Pearce's profession of incomprehension.	Capture CAP-02, B53; headerless top fragment not attributed.
August 10, 2026 capture	Pearce considers AI-assisted clarification; author acknowledges genealogy and requests collaboration or criticism.	Checked excerpt FB-02, B53; individual permalink unresolved; screenshot withheld for unrelated heading.
August 12, 2026 capture	Posted author answer explicitly affirms compelling other-minds inference and distinguishes proof.	Capture CAP-03, B53; triggering Pearce comment not visible.
September 8, 2026	Dated local draft of the NMP comparison.	After Matter, What Is "Physical"?, B09; draft date does not independently certify catalog publication date.

Date or displayed label	Event supported by the record	Source and limit
YouTube labels “1 month ago” to minutes	Bridge objection, supplied dilemma, repeated bridge proposal, request for public criticism, NMP abstract, primordial-fields question.	Comment-thread locator, B49; transcript order established, exact calendar dates unresolved. An August 7 screenshot anchors the initial exchange. The later quoted NMP formulation establishes wording available in that thread, not a calendar date inferred from a separate draft header.
Facebook labels “9w,” “2d,” “4h”	Earlier physicalism/math replies, later other-minds question, my practical acknowledgment, final conditional deferral of ethics.	B50 and specific reply links in Section 6; relative labels preserved, no fabricated intervening messages.
October 11, 2026	Revised documentary draft prepared and sent to Pearce for comment.	Author’s account of the invitation; private email not reproduced.
October 29, 2026	Invitation renewed; public compilation checked; this account updated.	Section 6.8 and B54. Inspection date does not establish first publication of the entries.

12.2. Objection, supplied answer, subsequent reply, unresolved question

Disputed point	Pearce’s position in the preserved record	Specific answer and its timing	What the subsequent reply addresses	Question left unresolved in that sequence
Realism and the other minds	A reality containing other sentient beings is his best explanation; later Facebook ethics is conditional on acknowledging beings beyond the world-simulation.	EE other-minds answer, B10, and my practical acknowledgment directly precede the final Facebook reply.	A real Pearce beyond the experienced avatar and the need for realist acknowledgment.	Why does my practical recognition fail ethically unless supplemented by the metaphysical credential?

Disputed point	Pearce's position in the preserved record	Specific answer and its timing	What the subsequent reply addresses	Question left unresolved in that sequence
The thalamic bridge	Shared experience could provide access to another animal's mind and transform ethics.	Bridge Trap, B11, supplied in the YouTube thread before the repeated proposal; my distinct-subject/merged-subject dilemma is also given before that reply.	Ethical impact and new phenomenology from a bridge.	How does the resulting experience authenticate an independently existing second subject, rather than establish a correlation or changed field?
NMP's additional ontology	Experience is the intrinsic nature of a physical reality described by adequate physics.	B09 abstract supplied before the late YouTube question about primordial fields. Earlier X replies already challenge the ontological promotion, without this later paper.	Whether I accept the realist cosmological history.	What empirical or explanatory capacity is lost when the extra realist commitment is withheld?
Mathematics and invariance	Mathematical truth does not depend on one person's cognitive phenomenology; Pearce explicitly favors nominalism.	Facebook answers link mathematical-Platonism criticism and B45's one-axiom account before later appeals to realism.	Independence and stability of mathematical/physical relations.	Does invariance establish a foundation outside experience? My earlier allegation of Platonism cannot be attributed to Pearce as an admission.
Phenomenalism	Pearce asks how EE differs from phenomenalism.	My next YouTube reply distinguishes complete subtraction and supplies B09.	His next question concerns experience-fields before life.	Does this engage the proposed distinction or presuppose the ontology being challenged?

Disputed point	Pearce's position in the preserved record	Specific answer and its timing	What the subsequent reply addresses	Question left unresolved in that sequence
Public scrutiny	Pearce acknowledges difficulty understanding EE.	My independent-public-introduction requests are explicit in the YouTube transcript and repeated after the NMP abstract.	Further philosophical questions appear in the captured replies.	No answer to the platform request is captured; no promise or global refusal is inferred.
Cryonics and cryothanasia	A specific final response by Pearce is not independently established in the recovered public record.	Published papers B31–B33 exist; the paper retains my account of attempted engagement.	A complete publishable response chain is missing.	Which exact arguments were received, when, and what did he answer?

These are relations between particular objections and answers. They are not a claim that every Pearce response was empty, that the answers have thereby been proved sound, or that repeated disagreement itself establishes bad faith. I am explaining why I judge these exchanges to have failed to confront the particular published arguments.

12.3. Source custody and exclusions

The published archive supplies the selected YouTube transcript, X replies and Facebook branch alongside screenshot evidence. Its source manifest identifies record types, capture dates, original and derivative hashes, and remaining gaps. The archive records the exchange; writing-process material and links are excluded.

The recovered Facebook branch was saved as a local research capture. A second supplied Facebook identifier resolved to the same post; it is not counted as another exchange. Some other reply branches remained collapsed, and the capture does not claim to exhaust the post. The screenshot of July 29 corroborates a notification; other screenshots tagging Pearce may contain statements by other interlocutors and must not be attributed to him merely because his handle appears.

Private correspondence expressly marked against publication is excluded. No contact addresses, private health information, or unrelated personal conversations are reproduced. The published primary-source archive, B53, now supplies selected public records, a chronology, hashes and explicit exclusions. Five screenshot derivatives remove ancillary metadata without altering pixels. They are not presented as byte-identical originals. A reference-only quarantine register remains outside that directory; private

originals and raw working records are not copied into it. I authorized public release on October 11, 2026. The archive is published on GitHub; evidence links identify files at the release commit. Its selection and evidentiary limits remain explicit, and private material remains excluded.

Corrections or newly recovered final posted versions should be incorporated as dated amendments. They must not silently turn a draft into a sent message, a source-record timestamp into a reply date, or an absent response into evidence of intentional suppression. The invitation remains: examine the actual disagreement, identify the error, and preserve the history accurately enough that it can be challenged.